

Charney's classic tofu with peanut sauce

This crowd-pleasing classic peanut sauce is loaded with **flavor**.

I recommend natural peanut butter (easy to find in health food stores and many supermarkets), not the traditional type loaded with fillers, sugar, and hydrogenated oils.

TIP This recipe makes a wonderful sauce for pasta salad and can be used for cold Chinese sesame noodles as well. Serve with rice and a salad.

3 tablespoons natural peanut butter

3 garlic cloves, peeled and smashed

2 teaspoons minced fresh ginger

1 tablespoon molasses

1 tablespoon toasted sesame oil

2 teaspoons honey

1 teaspoon soy sauce

1 teaspoon balsamic vinegar

½ to 1 chile pepper, seeded and chopped, or
1 teaspoon crushed hot red pepper

1 teaspoon salt

1½ cups vegetable stock or water [325ml]

1 pound extra-firm or firm tofu, drained,
pressed, and cut into about 6 to 8 rectan-
gles, 2 by 3 inches [5 by 8cm] [500g]

1. **Preheat** the oven to 400°F [200°C]. In a blender, mix all the ingredients except the tofu. Set the peanut sauce aside.
2. Line a baking sheet with parchment paper or aluminum foil. **Pour** about ⅓ cup [75ml] of the peanut sauce onto the baking sheet. Lay the tofu pieces on the sauce, then pour the rest of the sauce over the tofu, reserving 2 or 3 tablespoons. Smooth over with a butter knife to ensure all pieces are coated. Use the reserved sauce to top the tofu once it's cooked and ready to serve.
3. **Bake** the tofu for 15 to 20 minutes, or until the peanut sauce has hardened and darkened slightly.

SERVES 2 TO 4

variation If you prefer your tofu fried, with a light crunch, try this alternative.

Fry the tofu until lightly browned, cut into cubes while still warm, and toss in the peanut sauce. Let the tofu marinate in the sauce for 30 to 60 minutes. Serve warm or at room temperature.

